organizations need to avoid falling into the three stereotypes of the contracts with consulting firms, manpower firms and PR firms.

On their side, knowledge institutions also need to change gears in order to be useful partners. The ultimate purpose of an academic institution in India is to acquire metis, create authentic knowledge about India, to diffuse knowledge into India, and to be part of the process of changing India. Academic institutions need to shift gears away from a focus on publishing in international journals, which goes with catering to the interests and priorities of editors and referees who are far away.

The long-term foundations for policy research

In the short term, the Indian policy community has to make do with the academic institutions and researchers which are available. We must, however, recognize that these individuals and institutions are part of the fuller research ecosystem, where the key element is the universities.

Research and capability in the humanities and social sciences, all across the country, is what lays the foundations for policy-oriented research. The universities build the foundational papers and also build the people. The policy community reaps the fruits of the labours of the universities.

At a deeper level, a great deal of the difficulties that we have seen in India in recent decades are related to the atrophying of capability in the universities in the humanities and social sciences. India has invested in building science and technology at universities. In these fields, research done overseas is directly applicable in India, and India can actually free-ride on knowledge production overseas, but we build human capital by having universities in India.

We have cut corners on building humanities and social sciences at universities, and these are fields where knowledge on India can only be produced in India. Through this, we have hampered *knowledge* on India, and also the human capital in the country. Building the republic will require